

Messenger

Recent BlackBerries come with an instant messenger application called BlackBerry Messenger which only allows messages to be sent between BlackBerry devices

Push Pull

The term Push-Pull has its roots in supply chain management. It's now a widely used term on the internet, because of the way the email system works

Feature

full-QWERTY keypad, which made typing easier, the BlackBerry phones also offered a push mail service which was very attractive to corporates. Initially, the BlackBerry email system had to be integrated with a company's already present mail server for use of the push mail services. But once blood was tasted, everyone wanted the same kind of instant email access with services other than those related to their work life. That's when the concept of push email exploded into the tech scene.

If you were to visit the web site of a mobile service provider such as Vodafone, Loop Mobile, Reliance Mobile and Idea, all of them have a separate BlackBerry section where they offer BlackBerry phones along with their services, which include push email. The average cost of this service is approximately Rs. 499 per month with a limit of 500 Kb, which is a total rip off, in our opinion. If you intend to go for an unlimited scheme, it would cost you around Rs. 999 per month. These charges differ when it comes to companies and business schemes.

where you are constantly connected to the internet, the phone's data is only activated once a new mail has arrived at the mail server. When not using Push, your phone might check for new email every 15 minutes or so; during which the cell radio would be activated to check for new emails. This is a big drain on battery life.

One problem that push email faces is spam. If the user is prone to spam mail and does not have proper filters setup with his email account, then there is a possibility of getting spam mail every few minutes directly pushed onto your phone. This is definitely bad – if you're not using an unlimited data plan you might end up paying a bomb thanks to this junk!

Receiving and sending emails instantaneously can grow into a bad habit for some. The term 'Crackberry' has become quite popular and describes a person who feels compelled to reply to an email as soon as it reaches his inbox.

There are some groups that also believe email has not been created for instant

PUSH MAIL APPLICATIONS AND SERVICES

Emoze.com: This push mail application has two versions — Basic and Pro. The Basic version is free and lets you setup only one email account on your mobile phone. You can send and receive attachments only upto 100 KB with this basic version. The Pro version, on the other hand lets you setup multiple accounts and even allows you to create a folder on your phone where you can store emails. It works with Windows Mobile and

Symbian based devices.

Goolel.in: Goolel is the Hindi word for Slingshot, which in fact was the name considered for this application. The Goolel application offers many services including push mail. All you need for this is a phone that supports Java MIDP 2.0 and a GPRS service.

Movamail.com: This is another Java based application that

offers multiple features including push mail. MovaMail boasts of downloads in over 200 countries and support services such as Yahoo!, Hotmail, Gmail, AOL, POP3 and IMAP accounts. This service is free to try for 30 days and after that costs \$2.95 US per month.

Momail.in: Currently in the Beta phase, Momail offers the smallest and most optimised mobile email solution.

Myths and problems revealed

One of the most prevalent myth is that push email is only possible through BlackBerry phones. This is not true. Most phones now come with Push Mail features and setting it up is as easy as just typing a username and password. There are of course extra costs involved, especially with regard to your data plan be it WAP, GPRS, EDGE or 3G – this will vary from Rs. 49 per month to Rs. 500 and more per month, according to the service you choose.

Companies such as Nokia have launched their own Push Mail applications – Nokia Messaging, for their S60 platform based phones with include N-series and E-series phones.

Another thing to be noted is that Push Mail goes easy on the battery of your mobile phone. Unlike browsing on your phone,

messaging: if the content in an email is really that important then it would be wiser to just contact the person via phone.

Push mail is a sought after service by those who want to be in touch all the time through email, or by those who need to make split-second business decisions. Sure information can be passed by calling the person, but there are some who might ignore what has been said on the phone, with email a to-do is present in black and white and works as a means of proof when needed. In the corporate world, an email tends to be more of an official statement, so for those users, it definitely does make sense to go for push mail, but for the rest, you need to ask yourself how important push email might be, before you dip your toes in. **[1]**

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